

A NEW ECOSYSTEM

Windows 10 will have perhaps the biggest impact on the Windows ecosystem, and believe it or not it owes a lot to Windows Vista.

As you probably read in the previous chapter, Windows 7 and Windows 8 were both largely based on, and compatible with Windows Vista. As we also discussed internally the version of Windows Vista was NT 6.0 while that of Windows 7, Windows 8, and Windows 8.1 were 6.1, 6.2 and 6.3 respectively. In fact, even Windows 10 was initially given a version of NT 6.4 before Microsoft decided to number it 10.0 instead. However, this isn't because the core kernel of Windows has changed immensely.

However different they might have been in appearance, behaviour and performance, Windows 7, 8, and 8.1 internally represented themselves as minor point updates to Windows Vista (6.0) to signal to apps that the OS was compatible with Vista. Microsoft knew that Windows 7 and 8 were fully capable of running Windows Vista applications, so they in a way lied to these applications so these applications would run despite being written at a time when these new OSs were not even released. So does Windows 10 signal a break in compatibility? Not really.